the municipality decided in 2009 to offer free parking on Shabbat in a garage on Safra Square, near city hall. Thousands of ultra-Orthodox residents came out to protest, some of them throwing stones at police, who hauled out fire hoses to disperse the crowds. A leading rabbi threatened to "burn the city" if the lot was allowed to open. The mayor, Nir Barkat, suspended the plan for two weeks, which prompted a counter-protest by secular Jerusalemites. Seven years later, the lot is open, and the protests have long since stopped. Outside of ultra-Orthodox areas, Shabbat is much more lively today than it was decades ago.

Demographics and economics have helped the secular community. The ultra-Orthodox, with their large families and low incomes, are increasingly priced out of Jerusalem. They move to outlying communities, which dilutes their power. But the same demographics also offer a bad portent for non-Orthodox Israelis.

Jerusalem has a few volunteer "guardians of Shabbat", men who spend the holy day roaming the streets and yelling at motorists. One of them—after he got over his surprise that someone pulled over to chat—offered a confident prediction. "I have sixteen children," he said. "Maybe we're losing for now. But we'll win the demographic war."

"Widespread assimilation"

One day in the summer of 2016, a pickup truck laden with mattresses pulled onto my street, just south of the flea market and the old Jaffa port. The district is a mix of Jews, Christians and Muslims, and a model of coexistence, home to one of Israel's few bilingual Jewish-Arab kindergartens. The park where I walk my dog is called *Gan HaShnaim*, the "Garden of the Two", named for the Jewish woman who was killed in 1992 by a sword-wielding man from Gaza—and the Arab owner of a neighborhood garage, who ran out with a crowbar to defend her and was also cut down. Even at the height of the "stabbing intifada," when tensions were at a boil across the country, the neighborhood was almost entirely peaceful, save for a few teenagers who threw stones at a bus one night. The next morning, most of the local business owners wanted them tossed in prison.

The mattresses were headed for a formerly vacant house a few doors down from my apartment building. The original Arab owners fled in 1948,